

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: North

Lead: ♣Q

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Lead: ♥Q

Board: 3

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: South

Lead: ♣Q

Board: 4

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: West

Lead: ♠6

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 2
 ♥ 10 8 5 3
 ♦ Q J 10 3
 ♣ K 6 4 2

♠ A Q 9 6 5 3

♥ K 6 2

♦ K 8

♣ A 8



♠ K 8 4

♥ 9 7

♦ A 9 4

♣ Q J 10 5 3

♠ J 10 7

♥ A Q J 4

♦ 7 6 5 2

♣ 9 7

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	3 ♥	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			

4 ♠ by North

Lead: ♣Q

that if the ♠ finesse loses West will be able to get the lead and play a ♦ through your ♦ K 8.

So ask yourself: "How is West going to get the lead?" The only trick he could win would be the ♣K which he almost surely has. But you can keep this from happening by simply holding up on the first ♣ trick. Win the next one with your ♣A, enter dummy with a ♥ and take the ♠ finesse. It loses, but to East who can't hurt you with a ♦ play.

Recognize that West is the Danger Hand because he can lead a ♦.

Then think about how to keep West from getting the lead - in this case holding up on the first trick.

You open 1 ♠ and partner responds 2 ♠.

With 18 points you want to invite partner to bid game if he has 9 or 10 points. While you could do this with a 3 ♠ bid it is more informative to use a Help Suit Game try - bidding 3 of the suit you'd most like help in. You bid 3 ♥.

Partner has magnificent help in the ♥ suit so he bids 4 ♠.

North to play 4 ♠. East leads the ♣Q.

North to play 4 ♠. East leads the ♣Q. West plays ♣6.

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 1 : Total = 4

You know you are going to get to dummy with a ♥ and then try the ♠ finesse. Your big worry should be

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K J 6 2

♥ K 7 3

♦ J 4

♣ K 7 6 2

♠ A 5

♥ 9 6 5

♦ 10 7 6 2

♣ A 10 8 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 10 9 7 4 3

♥ A 8 2

♦ K Q 8

♣ 3

♠ 8

♥ Q J 10 4

♦ A 9 5 3

♣ Q J 9 5

West

North

East

South

3 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

Pass

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

Lead: ♥ Q

With four trumps and 11-12 points you have a pretty standard limit raise.

So you bid 3 ♠ and partner raises to game.

West would play 4 ♠.

East plays 4 ♠. South leads the ♥ Q.

East plays 4 ♠. South leads the ♥ Q.

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 1 : Total = 4

You have a loser in each suit and must eliminate one of them. Since the defense can take their Aces whenever they want to you need to find a place to put your "slow" ♥ loser. There are two possibilities, but each must be tried immediately because once you lose the lead the defenders will set up their ♥.

You could win the ♥ in your hand and lead toward the ♣ K. If South holds ♣ A you can establish the ♣ K for a ♥ discard.

You could win in dummy and set up a ♦ no matter which defender holds ♦ A. You could then discard a ♥ from dummy on your good ♦. This is obviously the better choice since it works with any distribution.

Win the first trick with dummy's ♥ K and play ♦ J. Continue ♦ s until they take the ♦ A. Win their return with your ♥ A and discard dummy's ♥ 7 on your good ♦. Only then do you start on trumps.

It was wise to choose to set up your ♦ rather than dummy's ♣ K because the ♦ play did not depend on a fortunate placement of the cards.

A very important part of this Plan was where you chose to win the first trick. Since entries are a problem with either hand you had to save the high ♥ as entry to the hand that would have the eventual winner.

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 9 4
♥ 6 2
♦ A 10 7 2
♣ Q J 9 7

♠ A K 5

♥ A Q 9 3

♦ K Q 4

♣ 6 5 2



♠ Q 10 8 3

♥ J 10

♦ J 9 8 3

♣ K 10 4

♠ 7 6 2

♥ K 8 7 5 4

♦ 6 5

♣ A 8 3

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	Pass	1 ♥
Pass	3 ♥	Pass	4 ♥
All Pass			

4♥ by South

Lead: ♣Q

loser on one of dummy's ♦ honors **IF** West has the ♦ A and **IF** you act quickly.

Win the first trick with your ♣A. Immediately play a ♦, putting up dummy's ♦Q if West plays low. Pull a round of trumps with ♥A, then another, getting back to your hand with ♥K. Play your other ♦. If West doesn't take his ♦A now then you no longer have a ♦ loser, so assume he takes it. The defense can now take their two ♣ winners, but when you get the lead again you can discard your ♠ loser on dummy's good ♦K.

It was important to start on ♦s at the second trick because you were conveniently in your hand and your hand didn't have other entries outside the trump suit. Not knowing how trumps would split you needed to make the first ♦ play right then.

This wasn't a guaranteed Plan like some. If East held the ♦A then you would go down.

You certainly want to show a Major suit so you respond 1♥.

Partner jumps to 3♥.

Your response showed 6-10 points and at least four ♥s.

Partner is inviting you to game if you are in the top of that range. With 9 points you certainly are so you bid the game.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♣Q.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♣Q.

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 2 : Total = 4

The defense will take their two ♣ tricks as soon as they get the lead. But you can discard your "slow" ♠

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 10 8

♥ A K 9

♦ J 8 7

♣ A 9 8 2

♠ K 9 7 6 3

♥ Q 5 2

♦ 5 4

♣ K J 4



♠ Q J 5

♥ 7 6 4

♦ K Q 10 6 3

♣ 6 5

♠ 4 2

♥ J 10 8 3

♦ A 9 2

♣ Q 10 7 3

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by West

Lead: ♠ 6

With a balanced hand and 16 points you open 1NT. In the Bridge dictionary under "Opening 1NT Bid" they probably have a picture of this hand. Partner responds 2NT.

Partner's 2NT bid is invitational. Specifically it tells you to pass with 15 points or bid 3NT with 17 points. But it doesn't tell you what to do when you have 16 points. So you have to make a judgement about your hand. Is it closer to 15 or closer to 17? The answer is definitely "closer to 17". Aces are actually worth a little more than 4 points and you have three of them. Also, most of your spot cards are higher than average, with only one card below a 7. So you bid 3NT.

West plays 3NT. North leads the ♠ 6, South plays ♠ 2.

West plays 3NT. North leads the ♠ 6, South plays ♠ 2.

Winner count: ♠ 2 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 1 : Total = 5

You are bound to get 2 winners in ♠s. You need to create 4 winners and the ♦ suit offers the perfect opportunity. Drive out the ♦ A and the other four ♦s are winners. But there is a very critical problem. If the defenders hold up their ♦ A until the third round of the suit you may be locked out of dummy.

Suppose you win the first ♠ with your ♠ 8. Then you start on ♦s and the defense wins the third one and leads a ♥. You win the ♥ but your only hope of reaching dummy is with a ♠. If you take your ♠ A, then lead a low one North will take his ♠ K and two more. Suppose you try to sneak over to dummy by playing your ♠ 10. North will jump up with ♠ K, then lead another which you must win with your ♠ A. No entry.

In hindsight the answer is simple. Win the very first ♠ trick with your ♠ A. That leaves dummy with the ♠ Q J and a sure entry. It seems strange to win a trick with a higher card than necessary but it is the only way to make this contract.

Here are the initial hands.

This shows the hands after five tricks have been played in the case where you took the first trick with your ♠ 8. You have just won trick 5 with your ♥ K.

Notice that no matter what you try North can prevent you from reaching dummy.

This shows the hands after five tricks have been played in the case where you took the first trick with your ♠ A. You have just won trick 5 with your ♥ K.

Notice that North cannot prevent you from reaching dummy with the ♠ Q J.